

## **COLLABORATIVE DISCUSSION 2: PEER RESPONSES**

Ariel Mella

12701097

Unit 10

Machine Learning

University of Essex Online

Hi Marwa, thank you. I appreciated the theme you put on the table: using AI to assist creativity without "tricking" the audience or being transparent about it.

Overall, I am in a similar line of thinking with your risk and benefits assessment. However, in order to address your question about disclosure, I believe more criticality is needed to answer that question.

Prior to answering when the right time is to disclose AI use, it is crucial to first define what "intellectual work" means and constitutes when we interact with generative AI. As an example: is engineering a prompt still considered human authorship or solely means that a tool is being operated? Thus, defining the "intellectual contribution" first is essential to answer the question when and how AI-generated content is disclosed to the readers. (Floridi and Chiriatti, 2020).

Additionally, preventive measures are needed to address the highlighted incidents concerning accountability and misinformation. Often, policy-makers are addressing this transparency issue through legislation. The European Union's AI Act ensures to address those risks proposing clear transparency obligations. Examples include mandatory AI watermarking (European Commission, 2021).

Thus, a clear legal definition of AI intellectual property together with technological measures such as the mentioned digital watermarks, can inhibit the spread of undisclosed or even misleading content. With that we could enhance the audience protection by ensuring AI is used as transparent and ethical tool to help perform not just administrative but also more creative, intellectual tasks.

## References

European Commission (2021) *Proposal for a Regulation of the European Parliament and of the Council laying down harmonised rules on artificial intelligence (Artificial Intelligence Act) and amending certain Union legislative acts*. COM/2021/206 final. Available at: <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=CELEX%3A52021PC0206> (Accessed: 23 June 2026).

Floridi, L. and Chiriatti, M. (2020) 'GPT-3: Its nature, scope, limits, and consequences', *Minds and Machines*, 30(4), pp. 681–694. Available at: <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11023-020-09548-1>

## Peer Response

Hi Abdullah, thanks for your post. I think you raise key points that many of us broadly agree with.

I would like to take your statements further: if there is a general consensus that AI can reduce time and costs in writing related fields, the question then becomes as to how we measure who produces the intellectual contribution. The human or the AI?

For example, if someone writes a piece assisted by AI, can that be copyrighted? Where are the boundaries? I did some further reading on this and found that defining originality and creativity when AI is involved is a complex issue, still on development.

The topic seems to be in the public discussion in recent times and specifically have reached the judicial system and governance bodies in US. The US Copyright Office emphasizes that copyright strictly requires "human authorship". This means purely AI-generated text cannot be copyrighted, but a work where a human meaningfully modifies or arranges AI content might be eligible for protection for those specific human contributions (US Copyright Office, 2025).

It seems to be an open debate with no clear-cut answers yet, and one that definitely needs further legal and academic research (Sobel, 2024).

## References

Sobel, B.L.W. (2024) 'Elements of style: copyright, similarity, and generative AI', *Harvard Journal of Law & Technology*, 38(1), pp. 49–51. Available at: <https://jolt.law.harvard.edu/assets/articlePDFs/v38/2-Sobel.pdf> (Accessed: 23 June 2026).

US Copyright Office (2025) *Copyright and artificial intelligence, part 2: copyrightability*. Washington, DC: US Copyright Office.